

Neue Haas

Unica

‘...Univers with a
heart, Helvetica
with a soul’

Beatriz Cifuentes and Yoshiki Waterhouse

Neue Haas Unica is the revival of a typeface that has attained almost mythical status in the type community.

Released by the Haas Type Foundry in 1980, Unica was developed by Team 77 (André Gürtler, Christian Mengelt and Erich Gschwind) as a hybrid of two existing fonts: Univers and Helvetica.

‘Sheer
Badassery’

Corey Holms

By the late 1970s, designers had been working with these two hugely influential fonts for more than two decades. They knew the strengths, weaknesses and best uses of each.

Haas identified a space between them for a font based on Helvetica but drawing on other sans-serif typefaces, most notably Univers – one more suited to the newly-established technology of phototypesetting.

‘More weights,
more letters,
more languages’

Unica hit the sweet spot. Understated, clean and elegant, it was warmer, less rigid and less mannered than Helvetica.

But it found only limited success. Desktop publishing rendered phototypesetting obsolete and both Helvetica and Univers were updated for digital use. Unica was sidelined. The typographic love-child became the lost child.

Until now.

'The Holy Grail'

Stefanie Weigler

Monotype's Toshi Omagari has analysed Unica and given this neglected classic a fresh, digital lease of life, with an extended range of weights for print and on-screen, and multi-language support.

Neue Haas Unica is available now from Monotype.

**‘It’s not bloody
Helvetica and
it’s not another
Helvetica’**

Bryan Edmonson

Ultra Light

Thin

Light

Regular

Medium

Bold

Heavy

Black

Extra Black

Ultra Light Italic

Thin Italic

Light Italic

Regular Italic

Medium Italic

Bold Italic

Heavy Italic

Black Italic

Extra Black Italic

Character Set

ABCDEFGHIJ
KLMNOPQR
STUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklm
nopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Uppercase

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
À Á Â Ã Ä Å Æ Ç È É Ê Ë Ì Í Î Ï Ñ Ò Ó Ô Õ Ö Ø Ù Ú Û Ü Ý Þ ß à á â ã
ä å æ ç è é ê ë ì í î ï ð ñ ò ó ô õ ö ø ù ú û ü ý þ ÿ Ž ž Š š Ŧ ŧ Ũ Ū Ů Ű Ų Ŵ ŵ Ŷ ŷ Ÿ Ź ź Ż ż

Lowercase

[illegible]

Small Caps

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
ÀÁÂÃÄÅĀĂĄÆÇĆČĎĐÈÉÊËĚĘĞĜĠĤ
İÍÎĨJĴĶŁŁ̣Ł̥Ł̧Ł̨Ł̩Ł̪Ł̫Ł̬Ł̭Ł̮Ł̯Ł̰Ł̱Ł̲Ł̳Ł̴Ł̵Ł̶Ł̷Ł̸Ł̹Ł̺Ł̻Ł̼Ł̽Ł̾Ł̿Ł̀Ł́Ł̂Ł̃Ł̄Ł̅Ł̆Ł̇Ł̈Ł̉Ł̊Ł̋Ł̌Ł̍Ł̎Ł̏Ł̐Ł̑Ł̒Ł̓Ł̔Ł̕Ł̖Ł̗Ł̘Ł̙Ł̚Ł̛Ł̜Ł̝Ł̞Ł̟Ł̠Ł̡Ł̢Ł̣Ł̤Ł̥Ł̦Ł̧Ł̨Ł̩Ł̪Ł̫Ł̬Ł̭Ł̮Ł̯Ł̰Ł̱Ł̲Ł̳Ł̴Ł̵Ł̶Ł̷Ł̸Ł̹Ł̺Ł̻Ł̼Ł̽Ł̾Ł̿Ł̀Ł́Ł̂Ł̃Ł̄Ł̅Ł̆Ł̇Ł̈Ł̉Ł̊Ł̋Ł̌Ł̍Ł̎Ł̏Ł̐Ł̑Ł̒Ł̓Ł̔Ł̕Ł̖Ł̗Ł̘Ł̙Ł̚Ł̛Ł̜Ł̝Ł̞Ł̟Ł̠Ł̡Ł̢Ł̣Ł̤Ł̥Ł̦Ł̧Ł̨Ł̩Ł̪Ł̫Ł̬Ł̭Ł̮Ł̯Ł̰Ł̱Ł̲Ł̳Ł̴Ł̵Ł̶Ł̷Ł̸Ł̹Ł̺Ł̻Ł̼Ł̽Ł̾Ł̿

Greek

ΆΈΗΊΌΥΩΐΑΒΓΔΕΖΗΘΙΚΛΜΝΞΟΠΡΣΤΥΦΧΨΩΪΫ
άέήίϋάβγδεζηθικλμνξοπρςστυφχψωϊϋόύώ

Cyrillic

ЁёЪъЃѓЄєІіЈјЉљЊњЋќЌќЎўЎўЎўЎўЎўЎўЎўЎўЎў
 ПРСТУФХЦЧШЩЪЫЬЭЮЯабвгдежзийклмно
 прстуфхцчшщъыьэюяёёђђєєіїјјљљњњќќўўўўўўўўўўўў
 ЖжҚқКкҢңҮүХхЧчҺһІіӨөӨө

Accents

\ / ^ ~ " = \ 0 // ' \ ||

5 6

Punctuation

" " " „„»«»<>¡¿?&*.,,:...•-—~_(/)[\]{^}|!+#!\$@™®©

Math and Currency Symbols

\$¢€£¥¦§¨ª«¬®¯°±²³´µ¶·¸¹º»¼½¾¿ÀÁÂÃÄÅ Æ ÇÈÉÊËÌÍÎÏÐÑÒÓÔÕÖ×ØÙÚÛÜÝÞßàáâãäåæçèéêëìíîïðñ
 ½¼¼³¼∏∫√ΔΩ∏∅ℓ°e

Numerals

0123456789

Superscript & Subscript

012345789
0123456789

Small Cap Numerals

0123456789

Proportional Small Numerals

0123456789

[illegible]



A graduate of Musashino Art University in Tokyo, type designer Toshi Omagari joined Monotype shortly after receiving his master's degree from the University of Reading in England. Proficient in drawing letters for the Latin alphabet, Omagari is also skilled at designing several other alphabets including Greek, Cyrillic and Mongolian. "Designing type is an opportunity to maintain the visual aspects of a culture, as well as to bring it forward," says Omagari.